Exploration rule – Diseases · SRD 5.1 / 5.2.1

A **disease** is above all a **story tool**: the SRD gives no general rule, only examples. A victim must pass a **Constitution save** to avoid infection; symptoms appear after an **incubation**, and each **Long Rest** is a chance to recover or worsen.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Contagion: **Con save** against a DC.
2. **Incubation**: a few hours or days.
3. Each **Long Rest**: a new save.
4. Cure: **Lesser Restoration** or treatment.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 doesn't detail diseases; this sheet reuses SRD 5.1 examples: to be checked.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD gives no general DC. Fix: pick a DC from 10 to 15 by severity.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the first signs (cough, fever) before the roll.

Step 1 – Exposure:

Bite, contact or tainted water: Constitution save.

Step 2 – Infection:

A failure infects the creature; nothing is felt at first.

Step 3 – Incubation:

Symptoms appear after 1d4 hours or days, or 1 day.

Step 4 – Long Rest:

At each Long Rest: a save. Success: the illness recedes; failure: it worsens.

Step 5 – Cure:

Lesser Restoration, herbalism or DM-approved care.

Example: Brann drinks tainted water (Sight Rot, DC 15). He fails: a day later his vision blurs.

Disease	Contagion	Main effect
Cackle Fever	Neighbors within 10 ft, Con DC 10	1 exhaustion level; mad laughter (Con DC 13)
Sewer Plague	Con DC 11 (bite, filth)	Exhaustion; reduced rest HP
Sight Rot	Tainted water, Con DC 15	–1 to sight attacks and checks, up to blindness

⚠ Common questions:

Who sets the DC?

The DM; examples range from 10 to 15.

When are the rolls?

Contagion, then each Long Rest.

What is incubation?

The delay before symptoms.

What does *Lesser Restoration* do?

It cures a disease or condition.

Do dwarves resist?

Poison, not disease.

Can herbalism cure?

Yes for some, like the eyebright ointment.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Spreading

Does a disease spread? **Option**: yes within 10 ft.

Quarantine

Does isolating lower the DC? **Option**: yes by 2.

Duration

Does a disease last forever? **Option**: 3 successes cure it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Save

Always a Constitution save.

Long Rest

It can worsen or cure.

SRD 5.1

Examples come from SRD 5.1 (2014).

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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